

ORSINO

Pursue him and entreat him to a peace:  
He hath not told us of the captain yet:  
When that is known and golden time convents,  
A solemn combination shall be made  
Of our dear souls. Meantime, sweet sister,  
We will not part from hence. Cesario, come;  
For so you shall be, while you are a man;  
But when in other habits you are seen,  
Orsino's mistress and his fancy's queen.

*(Exit all, except FESTE.)*

FESTE

*(Sings)*

*When that I was and a little tiny boy,  
With hey, ho, the wind and the rain,  
A foolish thing was but a toy,  
For the rain it raineth every day.*

*But when I came to man's estate,  
With hey, ho, the wind and the rain,  
'Gainst knaves and thieves men shut their gate,  
For the rain it raineth every day.*

*But when I came, alas! to wive,  
With hey, ho, the wind and the rain,  
By swaggering could I never thrive,  
For the rain it raineth every day.*

*But when I came unto my beds,  
With hey, ho, the wind and the rain,  
With toss-pots still had drunken heads,  
For the rain it raineth every day.*

*A great while ago the world begun,*



'FOR THE RAIN IT RAINETH EVERY DAY'

*With hey, ho, the wind and the rain,  
But that's all one, our play is done,  
And we'll strive to please you every day.*

*(Exeunt omnes.)*

FABIAN  
Good madam, hear me speak,  
And let no quarrel nor no brawl to come  
Taint the condition of this present hour,  
Which I have wonder'd at. In hope it shall not,  
Most freely I confess, myself and Toby  
Set this device against Malvolio here,  
Upon some stubborn and uncourteous parts  
We had conceived against him: Maria writ  
The letter at Sir Toby's great importance;  
In recompense whereof he hath married her.  
How with a sportful malice it was follow'd,  
May rather pluck on laughter than revenge;  
If that the injuries be justly weigh'd  
That have on both sides pass'd.

OLIVIA

*(To MALVOLIO)*

Alas, poor fool, how have they baffled thee!

FESTE

Why, 'some are born great, some achieve greatness, and some have  
greatness thrown upon them.' I was one, sir, in this interlude; one Sir  
Topas, sir; but that's all one. 'By the Lord, fool, I am not mad.' But do  
you remember? 'Madam, why laugh you at such a barren rascal? an you  
smile not, he's gagged?' and thus the whilfig of time brings in his  
revenges.

MALVOLIO

I'll be revenged on the whole pack of you.

*(Exit MALVOLIO.)*

OLIVIA

He hath been most notoriously abused.





‘GOOD MADAM, HEAR ME SPEAK’

# Colophon

The first documented public performance of *Twelfth Night* was on 2 February 1602. Twelfth Night—the night before Epiphany (6 January), or the twelfth night after Christmas—was, in Elizabethan times, a festival of licensed disorder presided over by a ‘Lord of Misrule’, so William Shakespeare’s (1564–1616) merry comedy of mistaken identities would have been suitably ‘topsy-turvy’ entertainment. *Twelfth Night* was first published by William Jaggard in London, in 1623, as part of *Mr. William Shakespeare’s Comedies, Histories, & Tragedies Published according to the True and Original Copies*: the ‘First Folio’. Illustrations by British artist William Heath Robinson (1872–1944) are from a 1913 edition published by Hodder & Stoughton in London (UK).

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OLIVIA

Have I, Malvolio? no.

MALVOLIO

*(Handing her a paper)*

Lady, you have. Pray you, peruse that letter.  
 You must not now deny it is your hand:  
 Write from it, if you can, in hand or phrase;  
 Or say ’tis not your seal, nor your invention:  
 You can say none of this: well, grant it then  
 And tell me, in the modesty of honour,  
 Why you have given me such clear lights of favour,  
 Bade me come smiling and cross-garter’d to you,  
 To put on yellow stockings and to frown  
 Upon Sir Toby and the lighter people;  
 And, acting this in an obedient hope,  
 Why have you suffer’d me to be imprison’d,  
 Kept in a dark house, visited by the priest,  
 And made the most notorious geck and gull  
 That e’er invention play’d on? tell me why.

OLIVIA

Alas, Malvolio, this is not my writing,  
 Though, I confess, much like the character  
 But out of question ’tis Maria’s hand.  
 And now I do bethink me, it was she  
 First told me thou wast mad; then camest in smiling,  
 And in such forms which here were presupposed  
 Upon thee in the letter. Prithee, be content:  
 This practise hath most shrewdly pass’d upon thee;  
 But when we know the grounds and authors of it,  
 Thou shalt be both the plaintiff and the judge  
 Of thine own cause.

ORSINO

This savours not much of distraction.

OLIVIA

See him deliver'd, Fabian; bring him hither.

*(Exit FABIAN.)*

*(To ORSINO.)*

My lord, so please you, these things further thought on,  
To think me as well a sister as a wife,

One day shall crown the alliance on't, so please you,  
Here at my house and at my proper cost.

ORSINO

Madam, I am most apt to embrace your offer.

*(To VIOLA.)*

Your master quits you; and for your service done him,  
So much against the mettle of your sex,  
So far beneath your soft and tender breeding,  
And since you call'd me 'master' for so long,  
Here is my hand: you shall from this time be  
Your master's mistress.

OLIVIA

*(To VIOLA)*

A sister! you are she.

*(Re-enter FABIAN, with MALVOLIO.)*

ORSINO

Is this the madman?

OLIVIA

Ay, my lord, this same.

How now, Malvolio?

MALVOLIO

Madam, you have done me wrong,  
Notorious wrong.

*(Reads)*

'By the Lord, madam,'—

OLIVIA

How now! art thou mad?

FESTE

No, madam, I do but read madness: an your ladyship will have it as it ought to be, you must allow *vox*.

OLIVIA

Prithce, read i' thy right wits.

FESTE

So I do, madonna; but to read his right wits is to read thus: therefore perpend, my princess, and give ear.

OLIVIA

*(To FABIAN)*

Read it you, sirrah.

*(She gives the letter to FABIAN.)*

FABIAN

*(Reads)*

'By the Lord, madam, you wrong me, and the world shall know it: though you have put me into darkness and given your drunken cousin rule over me, yet have I the benefit of my senses as well as your ladyship. I have your own letter that induced me to the semblance I put on; with the which I doubt not but to do myself much right, or you much shame. Think of me as you please. I leave my duty a little unthought of and speak out of my injury.—The madly-used Malvolio.'

OLIVIA

Did he write this?

FESTE

Ay, madam.